

Announcements

- PHP Assignment due Sunday Apr. 12
- Milestone 2 April 19
- RegEx Quiz tonight; due Tuesday before class.

Review of Last Class

Metacharacter	Description
/./	Matches any character
/doozy/	Matches exactly these characters
/^We/	Matches any string that starts with these characters
/day\$	Matches any string that ends with these characters
/! ?/	The character before the ? is optional
/o+ /	The character before the + appears one or more times
/o* /	The character before the * appears zero or more times
/ab{3} /	The character before the {n} appears at least n times
/ab{3,5} /	Indicates minimum and maximum number of times a character appears
/(ab)cd/	Parentheses form groups
/[aeiou] /	Character classes specifies options
/[a-z] / or /[0-9] /	Indicate a range with a hyphen
/[^a-e] /	Exclude the characters in this range
/[1-31](st nd rd th)\$/	indicates a logical OR

/doozy/

a i A
e E
/[aeiou]±/ix

^ caret or circumflex

/i - case insensitive match (matches regardless of case)
/x - ignore whitespace inside of the string

Specifying Options

Use the pipe | ^{or in java/php} (||) to specify logical OR
RegEx

[1-31] (st|nd|rd|th)

any digit between 1 & 31 one or the other of these

↳ <https://clayton.edu/search/index.php?q=cstem+symposium>

<http://mywebsite.com/login?username=bob&password=thisisbad>

Getting Data

2 built-in associative arrays known as PHP superglobals (aka autoglobals)

`$_GET`

`$_POST`

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
  <head>
    <meta charset="utf-8">
    <title>Example for User Input</title>
  </head>
  <body>
    → <form action="example_handler.php" method="get">
      ① <label for="name">Genre Name:
      ② <input type="text" id="name" name="genre">
      ③ <input type="submit" name="Add Genre">
    → </form>
  </body>
</html>
```

→ `$_POST['genre']`

① Genre Name: ② ③ Submit

http://localhost/2026-spring/example_handler.php?genre=Action&Add+Genre=Submit

2. Validate Data

- Make sure it is
 - not missing if required (NULL not allowed)
 - in correct format
 - correct data type (`is-numeric`, `is-float`, etc.)
 - correct format for what the data represents
- `preg-match` for RegEx
- Built in filter/validation functions

- preg-match for regex
- Built in filter/validation functions

filter_var (\$var, filter, \$options)

\$email = \$_POST['email'];

\$is-valid-email = filter_var(\$email, FILTER_VALIDATE_EMAIL);

```
<?php
$genre = $_GET['genre']; - grab the data from the get superglobal
echo "The genre is $genre"; - Simple echo to ensure it works.
```

```
function is_valid_genre($genre){
    $error = '';
    // check the genre is not empty
    // and that it has at least 1, but no more than
    // 50 characters
    // if true -- no error
    // if not -- return appropriate error message
    if(empty($genre)){
        $error = 'Genre must not be empty.';
    }
    if(!(empty) && preg_match('/[a-zA-Z]{1, 50}/', $genre) == 0){
        $error = 'Genre must be between 1 and 50 letters';
    }
    return array($error, $genre);
}
?>
```